

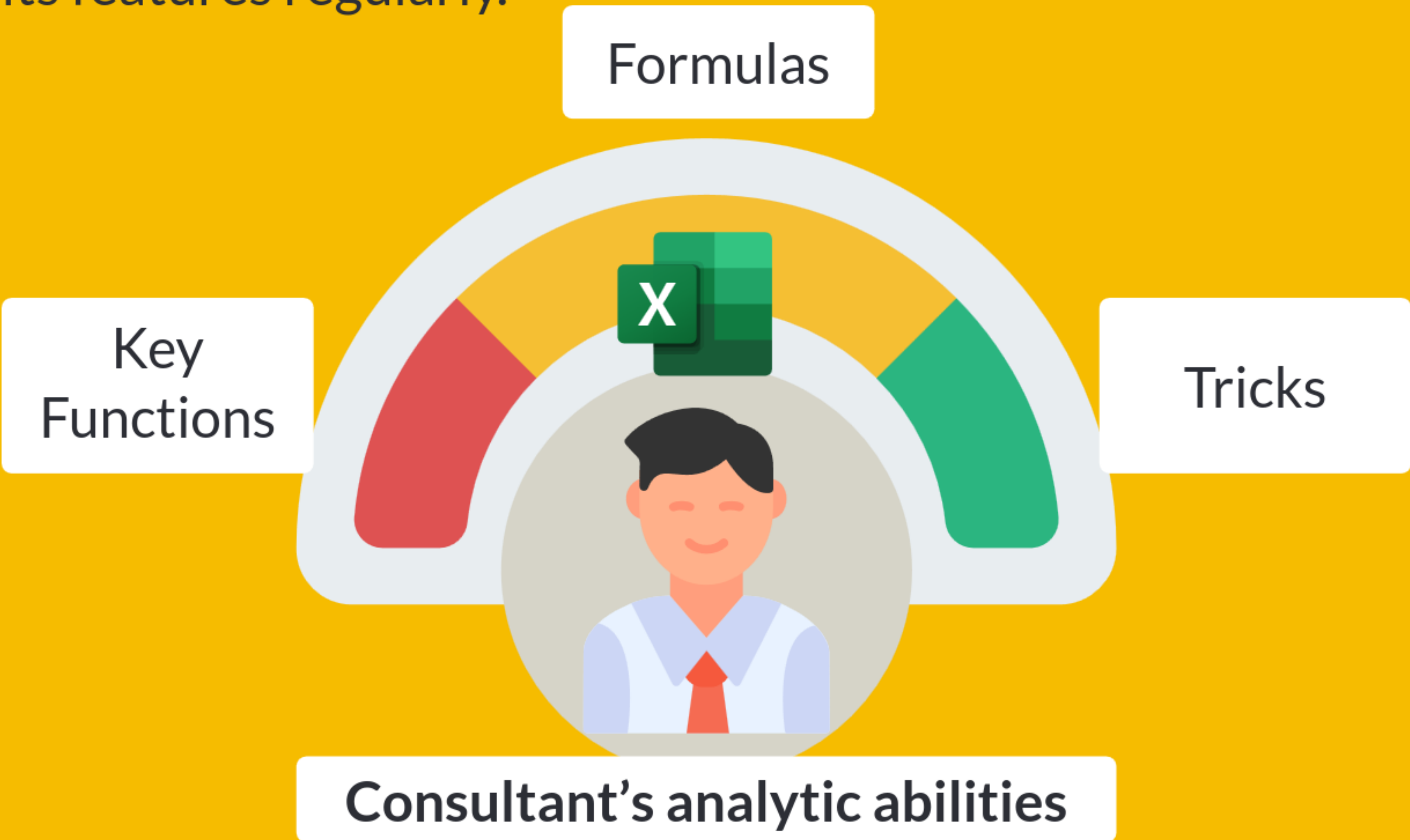
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Basic Functions and Formulae Mandatory for Consultants

While Excel is a vast repository of advanced data tools and programming capabilities, the good news is that consultants only need to use a small portion of its features regularly.

This core subset of Excel skills focused on key functions, formulas, and tricks is enough to turbo-charge a consultant’s analytic abilities. Mastering these basic to intermediate Excel operations is a solid foundation for rapidly proficiently using the software for day-to-day consulting work.

Here are the critical Excel skills in this ‘need-to-know’ category that every consultant must have in their arsenal:



Cell References

Cell referencing forms the primary language and building blocks to access data and create formulae in Excel. There are 3 main types of cell references:

Relative cell references	Absolute cell references	OR	Mixed cell references
Relative cell referencing is the default mode when referencing cells in Excel. <i>For example,</i> =A1+A2 adds the values in cells A1 and A2.	If either column or row component is ‘locked’ using \$ symbols, it becomes an absolute or mixed reference that remains constant when copied across cells. <i>For example,</i> =\$A\$1 is an absolute reference where the column and row are locked to A1 no matter where it is copied.		Using absolute and mixed referencing allows the creation of formulae that can dynamically adapt when replicated across cells - an extremely powerful capability for analysis. <i>For example,</i> =\$A1 is a mixed reference where only the column is absolute/locked to A, but the row can change.